Pupil studio resources & worksheet — Planning the piece: four composition choices

Pathway: TRACK · Week 3 Part 1 · Big question: How do four deliberate choices — focal point, palette, background pattern, and medium — shape an identity piece?

Arrival check

Look at the two mini thumbnail sketches on screen. Why do artists draw small rough thumbnails before starting on a big expensive board?

[ ] You can test two different layouts in four minutes and pick the strongest one

[ ] It stops you putting the main subject in an awkward spot on the big sheet

[ ] You can test which colour pair makes the focal point pop

Starter visual cues

Choice 1 (Focal point): Where does the main identity motif sit, and how big is it?

Choice 2 (Background pattern): How does a repeating geometric or organic pattern frame the motif?

Choice 3 (Colour palette): Two complementary colours plus one dark neutral for crisp edges.

Choice 4 (Medium pairing): Combining a dry line/pastel medium with a wet wash or collage ground.

Vote: What happens if your background pattern uses the exact same tone and line thickness as your central motif?

Studio practice planner

Lock in the four composition choices for your identity blueprint.

Shapes/Focus: Centred crest focal point, Rule-of-thirds motif, Framed portrait silhouette, Layered emblem badge

Tools/Methods: Radiating geometric pattern, Repeating botanical grid, Interlocking wave rhythm, Diagonal chevron ground

Exit ticket

What do we call a small, quick sketch used to test layout ideas before starting a final artwork?

[ ] A thumbnail sketch

[ ] A gallery label

[ ] A safety ruler